

OPERATIONAL EVENT REGISTER

Employee Handbook

PERSONNEL OFFICE // EFFECTIVE 15 APRIL 1998

ISSUED TO: _____

EMPLOYEE NO.: _____

COPY NO.: _____

ABOUT THIS HANDBOOK

This handbook describes how we work and what we expect of each other. It applies to every employee of the Operational Event Register. Where a procedure posted on the watch floor is more specific than this handbook, the posted procedure governs.

Keep this handbook at your seat or in your locker. Revised pages are issued by the Personnel Office and replace the pages they name. Return this handbook when you leave OER.

Questions about anything in this handbook go to your Watch Lead, your Technical Lead or the Personnel Office (EXT 4000).

FORM HR-HB // REV. 07/98 // PREVIOUS EDITIONS ARE OBSOLETE

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Acknowledgment of Receipt

Welcome to the watch.

You have joined a small organization with a single job: to see what is happening across the network, to make sense of it, and to write it down so that it is never lost.

Much of that work is quiet. Most watches pass with routine checks, careful turnovers and a log that says nothing unusual happened. That record matters just as much as the busy nights. A log is only trusted if it is kept the same way every hour of every day.

The people beside you on the floor will teach you more than this handbook can. Ask questions. Read the log. Take turnover seriously.

Welcome aboard.

THE PERSONNEL OFFICE
OPERATIONAL EVENT REGISTER

SECTION 1

About the Operational Event Register

The Operational Event Register (OER) watches the condition of regional systems and records what it observes, as it happens, in a permanent log. Eight regions report into one network. The watch floor reads those reports around the clock, correlates them, and records every condition and every action taken.

Our motto is printed on the seal: Monitor. Correlate. Preserve. Each of us does one part of that work, and the record is only as good as the least careful entry in it.

DEPARTMENTS

- Watch Operations: two crews (Red and Blue) staffing the watch floor 24 hours a day.
- Engineering: the systems, network, regional nodes, archive and feeds the watch floor depends on.
- Facility Security: building access, badges and visitor control.
- Personnel Office: hiring, pay, leave, records and this handbook.

SECTION 2

The Watch Schedule

The watch floor is staffed every hour of every day of the year, including holidays. Two crews share the work on a ten-day rotation posted at the watch floor desk. Each crew works Day Watch (07:00-19:00) and Night Watch (19:00-07:00).

POSITIONS

- Watch Lead: responsible for the floor, the log and every decision made during the watch.
- Watch COMM: all communications in and out of the floor.
- Watch Correlation: relates incoming reports to each other and to open items.
- Watch Monitoring: source and node status, scheduled checks.
- Crew Relief: qualified in more than one position; covers leave and absence within the crew.

ARRIVAL AND HOLDOVER

Arrive at least 15 minutes before your shift. No seat is left until it is relieved. If your relief has not arrived, you hold over, tell the Watch Lead, and record the time on your time sheet (Form HR-05). Holdover is authorized by the on-duty Watch Lead and filed on Form HR-11 within 24 hours.

SECTION 3

Shift Turnover

Turnover is the most important ten minutes of the watch. It is held at the seat, not in the break room, and it is never rushed.

- The outgoing watchstander briefs open items, entries in progress and anything unusual.
- The incoming watchstander reads the log back to the last turnover before accepting.
- The outgoing Watch Lead records that turnover is prepared; the incoming Watch Lead records acceptance. Responsibility changes at the acceptance entry, not before.
- Open items are carried by number until they are closed in the log.

SECTION 4

The Watch Log

The log is the permanent record of the watch floor. It is read by people who were not there, sometimes years later. Write for them.

ENTRY STANDARDS

- Make every entry at the time of the event, in local time, from the seat that observed it.
- Write what was seen and what was done. Leave opinions and guesses out.
- Use the record number of any item you refer to.
- Never erase, overwrite or remove an entry. A correction is a new entry that refers to the one it corrects.
- If in doubt whether something belongs in the log, it belongs in the log.

CLOCK CHANGES

Log entries keep local time. When the clocks change, the Night Watch on duty records the change in the log at the time it happens.

SECTION 5

Identification Badges and Access

Every employee is issued a photo identification badge. Wear it at all times inside the facility, above the waist and facing out. Badges are not lent, shared or left in vehicles.

Badges are re-issued when the badge system changes; the Personnel Office will schedule your new photograph. Bring your current badge to exchange it.

LOST OR DAMAGED BADGES

Report a lost badge to the on-duty Watch Lead at once. The badge is deactivated the moment it is reported. A temporary badge may be issued for up to five working days while a replacement is made (Form HR-03).

RESTRICTED AREAS

Equipment rooms, the archive and the regional node racks are open to Engineering and to watch staff with a logged reason. Doors that are posted as closed stay closed.

SECTION 6

Visitors

Visitors sign in and out at the watch floor desk and are recorded in the log by the Watch Lead. Each visitor wears a numbered guest badge for the whole visit:

- GC (green border): cleared visitors.
- GN (red border): visitors who are not cleared.

A visitor with a GN badge is escorted at all times by a named member of staff, including in the break room and restrooms. Consoles are turned away or cleared before a GN visitor enters the floor. Guest badges are returned at sign-out; a missing guest badge is reported like a lost badge.

SECTION 7

Attendance, Leave and Holidays

SCHEDULED LEAVE

Request scheduled leave on Form HR-01 at least 14 days in advance. Leave is approved against seat coverage, in the order requests are received. Approval is not final until it is entered in the leave record.

SICK LEAVE

If you cannot work a shift, call the on-duty Watch Lead before the shift starts. File Form HR-01 within two working days of your return.

SHIFT EXCHANGES

Two qualified staff of the same position may exchange shifts on Form HR-02, signed by both and by the Watch Lead. No one works more than two consecutive shifts.

HOLIDAYS

The watch floor is staffed on every holiday. Holiday pay applies to New Year's Day, Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Thanksgiving Day and Christmas Day. The holiday schedule is posted on the bulletin board each January.

SECTION 8

Pay and Timekeeping

Employees are paid every other Friday. Record actual hours on your weekly time sheet (Form HR-05), including holdover, and turn it in to the Watch Lead at the end of the last shift of the week.

Overtime must be authorized before it is worked, except holdover to cover an unrelieved seat. Overtime is recorded on Form HR-11.

Changes of address, name or tax status go to the Personnel Office (Form HR-09) within ten days.

SECTION 9

Emergency Call-Out

Every employee holds a place on the call-out tree, posted in the Personnel Office and at the watch floor desk. The tree starts at the watch floor desk.

- When you are called, call the people listed under your name.
- If someone cannot be reached within ten minutes, call the people they would have called.
- Report back up the tree when your branch is complete.

Keep your emergency contact form (HR-04) current. Home telephone numbers are held only in the sealed contact file and are never posted.

SECTION 10

Safety and the Facility

FIRE

Fire drills are held on each watch. The watch floor is never left unattended during a drill: the Watch Lead and COMM remain at their consoles and everyone else goes to the assembly point in the north lot. In a real alarm, follow the Watch Lead's instructions.

SEVERE WEATHER

Shelter areas are posted on every floor. The Watch Lead decides when the floor moves to its shelter posture and records it in the log.

HOUSEKEEPING

No food at the consoles. Drinks with lids only. The break room refrigerator is emptied every other Friday at 18:30; label your food with your name and the date. The watch floor temperature is set for the equipment.

SECTION 11

Conduct

Treat the people you work with, and the record you keep together, with care. Personal radios, televisions and games stay off the watch floor. Personal calls are kept short and away from the consoles.

Report any concern about safety, conduct or the integrity of the log to your Watch Lead, your Technical Lead or the Personnel Office. No one will be penalized for a report made in good faith.

SECTION 12

Confidentiality

What is seen on the floor stays on the floor. Log contents, console displays, call-out lists and personnel records are not discussed outside the facility, removed from it, or copied for personal use.

Requests for information from outside OER are referred to the Watch Lead, who records them in the log.

SECTION 13

Training and Performance Review

New staff complete the orientation checklist (Form HR-07) in their first two weeks, including two observed shift turnovers. Courses and qualifications are recorded on Form HR-10.

Watch floor staff are reviewed each year by their Watch Lead (Form HR-08). The review is discussed with you, and you sign it to show that it was discussed.

SECTION 14

Leaving OER

Give at least two weeks' notice to your Watch Lead or Technical Lead. On your last day return your badge, keys, pager, parking permit and manuals, including this handbook.

An exit interview is offered (Form HR-06). It is optional and confidential and is not placed in your personnel file.

FORM HR-HB-A

ACKNOWLEDGMENT OF RECEIPT

Sign the lower part of this page, detach it along the line and return it to the Personnel Office within five working days. It is filed with your orientation checklist (Form HR-07).

CUT HERE

I have received a copy of the Operational Event Register Employee Handbook (Rev. 07/98). I understand that it is my responsibility to read it and to ask about anything I do not understand, and that I must return it when I leave OER.

EMPLOYEE NAME (PRINT)	**EMPLOYEE NO.**
EMPLOYEE SIGNATURE	**DATE**
RECEIVED BY (PERSONNEL OFFICE)	**COPY NO.**



OPERATIONAL EVENT REGISTER

PERSONNEL OFFICE

PROPERTY OF OER // RETURN ON SEPARATION

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